policy experts, while being applauded on both the progressive left and isolationist right of the political spectrum. The greater geopolitical impact was felt in the emergence of three blocs in the Indo-Pacific.

The Emergence of Three Geopolitical Blocs in East Asia

Within months, or perhaps weeks, after the cease-fire and the announcement of Newsom's new policy, three distinct blocs had begun to form in the region. The first bloc was composed of a rump grouping of US alliances in the region. Japan and Australia remained allied with the United States, though not without significant changes to long-standing security policy. Within six months of Newsom's announcement, Japan had announced the imposition of a national draft for all eighteen- to twenty-five-year-olds for a period of three years; in addition, Tokyo's new National Defense Program Guidelines revealed a $200 billion plan to introduce autonomous systems into all of Japan's combat services, as well as the formation of a cyber warfare command. With only a token US force left in Japan, all US-Japan military exercises were canceled. Press reports by left-wing activist groups suggested that Tokyo had embarked on a secret nuclear weapons program in the northern island of Hokkaido, and that plans were under way to build several nuclear ballistic missile submarines to ensure a survivable counterstrike capability. While left-wing Japanese groups, again supported by Chinese intelligence and United Front operatives, demanded outreach to Beijing, Japan's conservative government reiterated its commitment to the modified alliance with Washington, though public opinion polls indicated that the government might lose its parliamentary majority to the liberal opposition.

Australia announced no change in its posture toward the United States but reiterated calls for full freedom of navigation throughout the Indo-Pacific. Canberra stated that it would be willing to port US Navy ships and expand facilities at the Royal Australian Air Force's Darwin base for the use of US bombers and fighters. Canberra's offer, however, was not immediately acted upon by Washington, which instead